



Bureau of Experts at the Council of Ministers
Official Translation Department

Handicrafts Law

Royal Decree No. M/49
August 25, 2025

Translation of Saudi Laws

NOTES:

1. This translation is provided for guidance. The governing text is the Arabic text.
2. The translation of Saudi laws takes the following into consideration:
 - Words used in the singular form include the plural and vice versa.
 - Words used in the masculine form include the feminine.
 - Words used in the present tense include the present as well as the future.
 - The word “person” or “persons” and their related pronouns (he, his, him, they, their, them, and who) refer to a natural and legal person.

For any comments or inquiries, please contact the Official Translation Department at:

otd@boe.gov.sa



No.: M/49

Date: 2/3/1447H

**With the help of Almighty Allah,
We, Salman bin Abdulaziz Al Saud,
King of the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia,**

Based on Article 70 of the Basic Law of Governance issued by Royal Order No. A/90, dated 27/8/1412H;

Based on Article 20 of the Law of the Council of Ministers issued by Royal Order No. A/13, dated 3/3/1414H;

Based on Article 18 of the Shura Council Law issued by Royal Order No. A/91, dated 27/8/1412H;

Upon perusal of Shura Council Resolutions No. 34/4, dated 24/3/1445H, No. 280/27, dated 27/10/1445H, and No. 330/33, dated 27/12/1446H; and

Upon perusal of Council of Ministers Resolution No. 157, dated 25/2/1447H;

Have decreed the following:

First:

The Handicrafts Law, attached herewith, shall be approved.

Second:

Current craftsmen shall be granted a period of one year from the date the Law referred to in Clause (First) of this Decree enters into force to amend their status in accordance therewith.

Third:

His Highness the Prime Minister, the ministers, and the heads of relevant independent agencies shall, each within their jurisdiction, implement this Decree.

Signed

Salman bin Abdulaziz Al Saud



Handicrafts Law

Resolution No.: 157

Date: 25/2/1447H

The Council of Ministers,

Upon perusal of Casefile No. 309, dated 1/1/1447H, received from the Royal Court, which includes Telegram No. 2673, dated 13/11/1442H, of His Highness the Minister of Culture regarding the draft Handicrafts Law;

Upon perusal of the aforementioned draft Law;

Upon perusal of the Statute of Heritage Commission issued by Council of Ministers Resolution No. 1012, dated 27/11/1445H;

Upon perusal of Minutes No. 256, dated 16/8/1444H, and Memoranda No. 679, dated 1/3/1444H, No. 2891, dated 21/9/1444H, No. 2389, dated 2/7/1445H, No. 2962, dated 15/8/1445H, No. 4075, dated 26/11/1445H, No. 78, dated 4/1/1446H, No. 530, dated 11/2/1446H, No. 1188, dated 7/4/1446H, No. 1851, dated 26/5/1446H, No. 3243, dated 27/9/1446H, No. 173, dated 18/1/1447H, and No. 654, dated 13/2/1447H, prepared by the Bureau of Experts at the Council of Ministers;

Upon perusal of Minutes No. 1535/46/M, dated 15/10/1446H, prepared by the Council of Economic and Development Affairs;

Upon review of Shura Council Resolutions No. 34/4, dated 24/3/1445H, No. 280/27, dated 27/10/1445H, and No. 330/33, dated 27/12/1446H; and

Upon perusal of Recommendation No. 1942, dated 23/2/1447H, of the General Committee of the Council of Ministers;

Resolves as follows:

First:

The Handicrafts Law, attached herewith, shall be approved.

Second:

Current craftsmen shall be granted a period of one year from the date the Law referred to in Clause (First) of this Resolution enters into force to amend their status in accordance therewith.

A draft royal decree has been prepared to this effect; a copy thereof is attached herewith.



Third:

Without prejudice to the jurisdictions of other government agencies, the Heritage Commission shall regulate the activity of handicrafts in accordance with the provisions of the Law and shall, in particular, undertake the following:

1. Preparing a list of handicrafts and submitting the same to the Ministry of Culture for approval.
2. Establishing and approving the National Register of Craftsmen in coordination with the Ministry of Culture.
3. Preparing quality standards for handicrafts and submitting the same to the Ministry of Culture for approval.
4. Setting and approving the arrangements and mechanisms necessary for exporting handicrafts outside the Kingdom and for activating local and international channels to market and sell handicrafts, in agreement with relevant agencies.
5. Drafting regulations for the training, qualification, and classification of craftsmen to be approved by the Board of Directors of the Heritage Commission.
6. Preparing apprenticeship programs and other training and knowledge transfer programs related to handicrafts, in coordination with relevant agencies.
7. Implementing national projects concerned with collecting and documenting handicrafts and establishing their geographical origin.
8. Preparing controls for manufacturing and marketing handicraft souvenirs and submitting the same to the Ministry of Culture for approval.
9. Licensing handicraft shops.

Fourth:

The Heritage Commission shall exercise the powers and duties stipulated in the Law referred to in Clause (First) of this Resolution as well as the powers and duties provided for in Clause (Third) of this Resolution, in cooperation with the Ministry of Culture and the entities that report to the Minister of Culture. The Minister may assign any of said powers and duties to the organizational units of the Ministry of Culture or to the entities that report to him in coordination with the Commission to ensure integration between the Ministry and the Commission in the exercise of powers and duties.

Fifth:

The Board of Directors of the Heritage Commission shall exercise its power to approve the controls referred to in Article 9 of the Law referred to in Clause (First) of this Resolution in agreement with the Ministry of Finance.

Signed
Prime Minister

Handicrafts Law

Chapter 1: General Provisions

Article 1

In this Law, the following words and phrases shall have the meanings assigned thereto, unless the context requires otherwise:

Law: Handicrafts Law.

Regulations: Implementing Regulations of the Law.

Ministry: Ministry of Culture.

Minister: Minister of Culture.

Commission: Heritage Commission.

Board: Board of Directors of the Commission.

Craftsman: Any natural or legal person who engages in a handicraft.

National Register of Craftsmen: A database in which information about craftsmen, including their classifications, handicrafts, and activities, is recorded as well as any other information specified in the Regulations.

Craftsman License: A license that authorizes its holder to engage in a specific handicraft for commercial purposes or to trade primarily in handicrafts.

Article 2

For purposes of the application of this Law, a handicraft shall mean any activity which relies primarily on manual work and aims to produce items the design, shape, and artistic and decorative elements of which are derived from the inherited cultural heritage of the Kingdom's regions, or which aims to provide services relating to handicrafts. Such activities shall be divided into the following categories:

- a) Artistic or traditional handicraft production, which is any activity that aims at producing items by transforming raw materials into finished or semi-finished handicraft products, provided that more than half of the production processes are carried out by hand.
- b) Handicraft service, which is any activity that aims to provide a handicraft service, including repair, maintenance, or restoration, or to provide marketing services or the like.

Article 3

This Law aims to regulate and develop the activity of handicrafts in a manner that contributes to promoting and preserving inherited national cultural heritage and protecting it from extinction as well as promoting the competitiveness of products and services, and marketing them locally and internationally.

Chapter 2: Registration in the National Register of Craftsmen and Licensing Craftsmen

Article 4

1. A craftsman may apply for registration in the National Register of Craftsmen.
2. The application for registration in the National Register of Craftsmen shall be submitted in accordance with the conditions and mechanisms specified in the Regulations.
3. No person may engage in a handicraft for commercial purposes or trade primarily in handicrafts without obtaining a craftsman license from the Commission.

Article 5

1. Without prejudice to relevant laws and decisions, the Regulations shall specify the controls governing the participation of craftsmen representing the Kingdom in conferences, forums, events, and exhibitions held within the Kingdom or abroad.
2. A craftsman may not represent the Kingdom in conferences, forums, events, and exhibitions held within the Kingdom or abroad without satisfying the controls referred to in paragraph (1) of this Article.

Article 6

1. To obtain a craftsman license, the license applicant must be registered in the National Register of Craftsmen. The Regulations shall specify any other license requirements.
2. A craftsman license shall be issued and renewed pursuant to a decision by the Commission, in accordance with the Regulations.
3. The Regulations shall specify the term and types of the craftsman license.

Chapter 3: Duties and Prohibitions

Article 7

A craftsman, or a person who trades in handicrafts, must comply with the quality standards of handicrafts approved by the Ministry.

Article 8

It shall be prohibited to import the handicrafts specified in the Regulations or make replicas thereof.



Chapter 4: Financial, Technical, and Marketing Support

Article 9

The Commission may, in accordance with controls to be approved by the Board and within the limits of the allocations and financial resources available thereto, grant incentive bonuses to craftsmen.

Article 10

1. The Commission shall cooperate with relevant public and private sector entities to establish, supervise, and equip centers, villages, and complexes for craftsmen to enable them to practice their handicrafts, provide them with relevant training, and market their services and products, and to conduct studies and research to develop handicrafts, in a manner that enhances the appeal of such centers, villages, and complexes.
2. The Commission shall coordinate with the competent agency to take the measures necessary to classify handicrafts as small enterprises.

Article 11

The Commission shall encourage the establishment of specialized associations for handicrafts.

Chapter 5: Violations and Penalties

Article 12

1. Employees designated pursuant to a decision by the Minister shall carry out the duties of monitoring and inspection as well as the detection and recording of violations provided for in this Law; such employees shall have the power to detect and record violations.
2. The Ministry may seek the assistance of any public or private entity to carry out the duties of monitoring, inspection, detection, and recording, in a manner that is not inconsistent with relevant laws, regulations, and decisions.

Article 13

1. A committee, or more, comprising three members, including a legal advisor and a specialist in handicrafts, shall be formed pursuant to a decision by the Minister. Such committee shall consider the violations provided for in this Law and impose the penalties and measures provided for in Article 14 of this Law.
2. The term of the committee shall be three renewable years.
3. A person against whom a decision is issued by the committee may appeal such decision before the administrative court.
4. The committee's work rules and procedures as well as the remuneration of its members shall be determined pursuant to a decision by the Minister.



Article 14

1. The Commission shall issue a warning to any person who violates the provisions of Article 4(3), Article 5(2), and Articles 7 and 8 of this Law, and shall grant the violator a period to rectify the violation; such period shall be specified in the Regulations.
2. If the violator fails to rectify the violation within the period referred to in paragraph (1) of this Article, the committee provided for in Article 13 of this Law shall, without prejudice to any penalty provided for in any other law, impose a fine not exceeding twenty thousand riyals, or take, either in addition to the fine or independently thereof, one or more of the following measures, as the case may be:
 - a) Withholding, wholly or partially, any privileges granted to the violator.
 - b) Removing the name of the craftsman from the National Register of Craftsmen for a period not exceeding five years.
 - c) Suspending the craftsman license for a period not exceeding one year. The period for which the name of the license holder is removed from the National Register of Craftsmen shall be the same as the license suspension period if this measure is combined with the measure provided for in paragraph (2)(b) of this Article.
 - d) Canceling the craftsman license.

Article 15

The maximum fine provided for in Article 14(2) of this Law may be doubled if the violator repeats any of the violations punishable under the provisions of this Law. A violation shall be deemed repeated under the provisions of this Law if it is committed within three years from the date a final decision establishing such violation is issued.

Article 16

The Regulations shall specify the procedures for reinstatement in the National Register of Craftsmen following the removal of a craftsman therefrom, and the procedures for the reissuance of a craftsman license after its cancelation.

Chapter 6: Final Provisions

Article 17

The Minister shall issue the Regulations within a period not exceeding 120 days from the date of publication of this Law in the Official Gazette. The Regulations shall become effective on the date this Law enters into force.

Article 18

This Law shall enter into force 120 days from the date of its publication in the Official Gazette, and shall repeal any provisions conflicting therewith.